

That same year, 1831, William Lloyd Garrison printed the first copy of his abolitionist newspaper, *The Liberator*. He saw slavery as a grave national sin and demanded its immediate abolition. Two years later, he helped form the American Anti-Slavery Society (AAS) with many members drawn from evangelical churches in New England and western New York. Many of these religiously inspired activists saw Black people and white people as one family created by God, although many were reluctant to accept the notion of full social equality. Garrison and his followers also alienated more traditionalist abolitionists by supporting women's rights. Some Southerners saw a link between *The Liberator* and Nat Turner's insurrection and demanded that Garrison's paper be shut down.

1,350 The number of chapters in the American Anti-Slavery Society in 1838—a more than threefold increase in three years. With 150,000 members, the society was a small but vociferous proportion of the population.